



Elise Bernhardt - 00:00

Would it be under. I think I've filed it already.



Alexandra Nyashina - 00:08

You want me to send it up or put it on the screen?



Elise Bernhardt - 00:10

Oh, yeah, sure. That'll save us a lot of time.



Alexandra Nyashina - 00:16

I might as well. I'm going to be staying here and then I'm earning my keep.



Elise Bernhardt - 00:21

Hang on a second.



Alexandra Nyashina - 00:23

By the way, I'm in the process of saving the Jerusalem page. I saved it already. Just our files, and I should be done by tomorrow. Saving it in the Wayback Machine so anybody can access it, you know, in the future, but it's there.



Elise Bernhardt - 00:42

Brilliant. Brilliant.



Alexandra Nyashina - 00:44

You're almost out of there.



Elise Bernhardt - 00:48

Very excited. And save us some money. I also, just so you know, I wrote to all the fellows. I'm feeling a little sad because none of them have gotten back to me yet, but I did just write to them yesterday, so. All right, let's go through this really quick.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:02

This is new. I've never seen this before. Textbooks. Look at that. All right.



Elise Bernhardt - 01:10

All right, let's see.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:10

Hello.



Elise Bernhardt - 01:11

Yeah, it works.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:12

Okay, let's do it.



Elise Bernhardt - 01:13

Okay, roll away. Yeah.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:16

Can you see it? Do you need data?



Elise Bernhardt - 01:18

Yeah. Okay.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:21

She says, not knowing what she's doing here, I'm gonna. I'm gonna do something weird.



Elise Bernhardt - 01:32

Okay.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:33

You've known me for, like, three times, so.



Elise Bernhardt - 01:35

Yeah, you go. Go, girl.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:37

Get used to this. The weirdness only continues. I'm gonna do an entire screen. Okay. This is the screen. So I'm not going to see you anymore.



Elise Bernhardt - 01:48

All right.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:48

Now they blame us.



Elise Bernhardt - 01:51

All right.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:54

I love this. This is so funny for me. Okay, here we are. Can you see this?



Elise Bernhardt - 01:58

Yep, yep.



Alexandra Nyashina - 01:59

Okay. And then we go. So this is how it started.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:04

Your questions, because. Yeah, yeah.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:08

Really?



Elise Bernhardt - 02:10

Now. Now it's like I'm feeling at home. Why? Because that's what would happen to me. All right.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:18

Please.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:18

Yeah, yeah.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:19

We're not that fancy over here. The world is just exactly like that.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:25

I.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:25

Almost there.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:26

Oh, well, while we're waiting, look what I found. Hold on.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:31

I can't see you.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:32

Oh, it's the report from 2014. The plan, practically. It's gonna shorten everything.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:40

Good.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:40

Because a lot of it is. Is 12 years later still accurate?



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:44

Yeah.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:44

Okay.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:46

All right, we'll scroll down.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:49

Okay.



Alexandra Nyashina - 02:52

Yeah.



Elise Bernhardt - 02:52

Old calendar. Correspondence with Uri. It's Uri, just U R I, not Ori. But that's, you know, minor detail.



Alexandra Nyashina - 03:01

That's a good detail to know. Because afterwards, people are reading it. They're like, who the heck is this?



Elise Bernhardt - 03:06

Yeah, I. Yeah, so it's Uri Dromi, and I can't. I don't even know where I'd find it.



Alexandra Nyashina - 03:15

Not a problem.



Elise Bernhardt - 03:17

Draw me. D R O M I T R O M I. Okay, Remember about the Israeli dance company and artist Renee. And it begins with a P. Good. I'm gonna look up Israeli dance companies, contemporary Israeli dance companies, while we're talking, and I will have a name for you.



Alexandra Nyashina - 03:45

And the good news is all of this is being recorded, so I'm actually not going to type it in because.



Elise Bernhardt - 03:50

Why? I can see her face, but I can't come up with her name. And that happened to me. Anyway, keep going.



Alexandra Nyashina - 04:00

Okay,.



Elise Bernhardt - 04:03

So first year. Oh, here we go.



Alexandra Nyashina - 04:05

Too much. What was it about? Josh Seraphim. Specifically Beyond Urban Planet.



Elise Bernhardt - 04:12

Oh, it was involved. Pinto. Oh, Pinto. That's her name.

Alexandra Nyashina - 04:17



Love it.



Elise Bernhardt - 04:18

Yeah, I know. Thank God for AI, right?



Alexandra Nyashina - 04:24

How do you spell that?



Elise Bernhardt - 04:25

I N B A L in Bal B A. Pinto. P I N T O.



Alexandra Nyashina - 04:36

Okay, good. Josh.



Elise Bernhardt - 04:42

Oh, what was it about Josh besides that he was an urban planner and he was smart and I knew him and he was making a name for himself. And.



Alexandra Nyashina - 04:58

Why did you like him?



Elise Bernhardt - 05:00

Why do I like. Well, I've known Josh since he was like 20. Nothing. He was an intern for me.



Alexandra Nyashina - 05:05

She must have impressed you somehow.



Elise Bernhardt - 05:07

Well, he is very, very smart. He's very smart and very savvy and very, you know, and he was working in the Bloomberg administration, which, you know, was. The Bloomberg administration was doing so much and he was like right at the heart of it because he was working with Dan Dr. Off, who basically changed the face shape of New York in so many ways. So those are the kind of people, how would I say this proximity to the city. Proximity to. To city planning. And. Well, I think what I knew was that Jerusalem had no city plan. Like, I think it came from the fact that there is no city planning at all.



Elise Bernhardt - 05:53

And so, like, I didn't know that many urban planners, but I knew Josh was an urban planner and I knew Josh was really close to what was going on in New York, which arguably is not so well planned either. That's an important thing.



Alexandra Nyashina - 06:07

So you were looking to find.



Elise Bernhardt - 06:08

To close the gap and that admit. Yes. And that administration was in particular involved in some very serious planning in terms of, well, you know, like waterfront usage, La la ferries. So I'm trying to remember who it must have been on some visit or talking to Uri or talking to someone that, you know, the absence of urban planning in Jerusalem struck a chord.



Alexandra Nyashina - 06:41

Good enough. That's good.



Elise Bernhardt - 06:44

I think that's. That's where we. That's I can't remember the name of the administrator and I don't think it, in the, in this scheme of things. I don't think it's that important.



Alexandra Nyashina - 06:56

There you go.



Elise Bernhardt - 06:57

Just, you know. Yeah, it's not.



Alexandra Nyashina - 06:59

What about the footage from the 2010.



Elise Bernhardt - 07:02

Videographer who filmed Reggie's work? Oh, well, what about it? Where would it be? Where would it be? I'll ask Reggie or I don't think websites in those days, I don't even think we could post videos on websites. So even if I could access the FJC website, I don't think it would be there. I'll ask Reggie to do about it. I, I, he might still have it, you know, it was a long time ago.



Alexandra Nyashina - 07:37

It was. All right, let's see what else we got.



Elise Bernhardt - 07:39

Oh, too much. I mean a lot of this is going to be figuring out where the hell I put stuff because by the way, I did look in that big box much. I mean I found this, I found the beautiful evaluation which you know, we printed up and it's very gorgeous and it's got some of, you know, but that's fine. Otherwise it doesn't have any documents. It's got like books and catalogs.



Alexandra Nyashina - 08:07

Yeah, that's pretty good because that's what makes it right.



Elise Bernhardt - 08:10

It's the conversations, you know, I have this week in Palestine from February 2013. Yeah, it's really random, sadly. Anyway, we'll continue. I have to like do some deep dive into I don't know what. We'll get there.



Alexandra Nyashina - 08:30

We'll get there. I promise you.



Elise Bernhardt - 08:34

Conditions did what I remember from Lynn, and she can say more is that she took an old or not an old, an Arab math textbook and she cut it up and repurposed it into. And I actually I think I have some of these prints. In fact I do have some of these prints. She gave me some to what do you call it? Not auction to give to donors. And I still have a bunch.



Alexandra Nyashina - 09:05

Yeah, we'll just, if we can, we'll try to digitize it or at least take pictures of it or something.



Elise Bernhardt - 09:10

Oh, and the name of it's the poet is Michal Govrin. That's her whole name and it's Michal M I C H A L Love.

Okay.



Elise Bernhardt - 10:07

She likely has all kinds of things, and yes, I can reach out to her. I know where she is. I haven't talked to her in a while, but yes. Don't remember Judy's last name and probably never will. Beth's last name is Steinberg.



Alexandra Nyashina - 10:27

Steinberg.



Elise Bernhardt - 10:29

Is she now?



Alexandra Nyashina - 10:30

Do you know what she's up to now?



Elise Bernhardt - 10:32

Oh, yeah. Beth lives in Jerusalem. She. She co founded and I guess still co directs a program called Shoe Tough, which is for kids with developmental things. And she also runs something called Theater in the Rough, which is English Shakespeare in English in Jerusalem. And they do public performances every year. She's something. She's something else. And she's actually gonna be in New York, although I. If I see her while she's in New York, I will ask her some questions. Yeah, I'll turn the recording on and just do that. Palestinian. I still haven't found him, but I have his book somewhere and I can see his face and it will come to me.



Alexandra Nyashina - 11:28

Okay, fair enough.



Elise Bernhardt - 11:30

Wait, I'm gonna do a Google search. Alice. Poet and painter living. And I remember that he had a rose garden in Jericho. Why do I remember that? Because I'm jealous of anybody. No, no, they're doing all. Not famous. No, they're all doing Mahmoud Art. Darwish.



Alexandra Nyashina - 12:08

Foreign.



Elise Bernhardt - 12:09

Let's try living. Nor Shama Host. Okay. I'll have to, like, figure out where that lives in my. Where that book might live. Okay, keep going. David. And it's David's son. Norris didn't make the book. And I am still in touch with him. Like, you know, he's one of the people who, when I was trying to figure out how were gonna wrap this up, he was one of the people who I consulted with. Okay. Susie Korda, she was actually on the website. Susan. Susie Korda or Susan Korda was with a K. Yeah, and there's. There's stuff in the. Yeah, there's stuff in the plan that says something about Susan Korda. Where'd it go? I can. All right, well, we'll go through this and see. There's. Oh, yeah, there's an example. Norris is editing his 7,000 photographs for a book on Jerusalem Light.



Elise Bernhardt - 13:32

And the other one. Yeah, the Great thing about this plan for the future is it talks about all the things I've already talked about in terms of the character of Jerusalem, why it's so interesting. Sworn there was something about Susie Court of seeing. Seeing. Going back to Jerusalem. Anyway, I have a little bit of a cookbook here already. Nice. All right, wait, there was one question. Ruth Cummings.



Alexandra Nyashina - 14:08

Yeah.



Elise Bernhardt - 14:09

Okay, so Bruce Cummings. I don't remember what she was doing exactly when this all started. Later she started an organization called Jerusalem Culture Unlimited, but that was until, I don't know, like five or six years ago. So when I first met her, I don't know, she was raising her kids and I'd have to ask her. I'd have to ask her. I'm in touch with her. When we first met in 2010, what was she doing? I don't remember exactly, but she knew everybody culturally. She was very involved. And then she later founded this organization which was based on helping small cultural or

small non profits. What's that word? Capacity. Help them grow their capacity.



Alexandra Nyashina - 15:08

Capacity building.



Elise Bernhardt - 15:09

Yep. I think she was. I don't know if she was the chair of the board of the Cummings Foundation. She certainly was on the board of the Cummings Foundation. I think at some point in there she was the chair. Now her daughter's the chair. It's kind of cool. In any case, that's Ruth. All right. Walk you through the seven years, trip by trip.



Alexandra Nyashina - 15:33

I got time, baby.



Elise Bernhardt - 15:36

That's really funny. Yeah. Where does that calendar live? I do have a. I do have a stack of journals in my house which are dated so I can look through them. Oh my God,.



Alexandra Nyashina - 15:55

Now you're regretting all of this, huh?



Elise Bernhardt - 15:57

Yeah, because I don't, you know, calendars, it wouldn't be on this machine. I'd have to see. I went like once or twice a year and. Well, anyway, I think I'll start at the beginning of 2014. I went to Bellagio. I thank God it was the. Oh, how did. I must have applied for it. I must have knew. Knew. I must have known this was coming because the. Trying to remember the dates. See if I have the dates of the 2013. Well, it was actually. It was in the. Must have been in the winter, like October, November, December were the dates of. Twent of the. Were were the dates of the 2013. Yeah, it was in the fall of 2013 and I must have already applied for the Bellagio Fellowship.



Elise Bernhardt - 17:16

And so I went to Bellagio in April of 2014 and the proposal was to do a plan for the future of The American Academy in Jerusalem, because the foundation had. Had gone. Had folded. Yeah, I won't go through how. How lovely it was to be in Bellagio. And Aggie Gund, God bless her, the philanthropist was there and she did help support, you know, she gave \$10,000 to the 2022 residency. And this is not for publication, but it didn't take me four weeks to write this thing. It was pretty much all in my head. And, you know, then I had to do a budget and I had to do a timeline, and that probably took me longer than anything else was to make a pretty timeline. There was no clog, but everything else was just gathering quotes and gathering.



Elise Bernhardt - 18:28

So we had this nice report, and the idea was that I was going to trot this around and see if I could get funding and talk to people in Jerusalem. One of the. Be writing things down here. One of the things that I. Hold on. I'm making myself a little list of stuff to do because I need to talk to James Snyder. And one of the things I need to do with James Snyder is figure out when. Well, that's easy enough to do. James. James Snyder was at the Israel museum when the 2013 residency happened. And then when I created an advisory board, I invited him to be part of it. And then he moved to the Jerusalem Foundation. And I can't tell you exactly what year that was, but it was somewhere between 2013 and 22.



Elise Bernhardt - 19:36

So he knew from 2013 he knew the program pretty well. And he was the person who suggested we make it international and that we call it Jerusalem. You know, we kicked around a bunch of names with this advisory committee. And I can send you the names of the advisory committee, which is Ruth. I can almost do it. I can. Ruth Cummings, James Snyder, Joe Melillo from bam, who has been a very longtime friend and certainly had been one of the people who recommended artists. Joel Levy, who had been at the American Academy in Berlin. And I don't know if he would say it or I would say it, or that he sort of made the American Academy in Berlin possible because he had been a diplomat and somehow he got this post and he brought in famous diplomat who sort of saved the place.



Elise Bernhardt - 20:39

So he understood how that place works. And then he was at the center for Jewish History. He was sort of their interim CEO, or maybe in any case, doesn't matter. But Joel was an important advisor. Joel, Joe, James. There was another J. I don't know why I'm looking this. I mean, I have this. I don't know why I'm even Bothering to try and remember this because it's all written down. Someplace in here. It's on the website. My advisors. I know we'll find them. Yeah, it's in the website. Ruth, James, I think a couple of the fellows were also part of my advisory committee. Joel helped us organize a small fundraiser in New York. None of them were really. They didn't really. Some of them contributed but that was kind of not their real purpose. Anyway.



Elise Bernhardt - 21:55

James was definitely the person who renamed it was like Jerusalem International Fellows. And I don't know if we did it over lunch and we kicked it around or you know, and he's very convincing and I think one of the things that I did in the back and forth over many years was get to know people in East Jerusalem and there were a few people

who helped me do that. Ruth was one of them, Reman Barakat, who I don't know. She was working for a kind of festival agency. Woman named Karen. I'll talk about Karen later. She's Karen. Karen worked at Schusterman. The Schusterman foundation had an office in Jerusalem and I, I sometimes use that actually I did use that as my kind of back office in 2013.



him, oh, come on, what's in a name? And I will never forget.



Elise Bernhardt - 27:03

So in one of my visits, I met the woman who was running the Paley center, which was this little, tiny, wouldn't call it quite a museum workshop that was kind of part of the Israel Museum, sort of tucked underneath it in just across the line between west and East Jerusalem. And I have to try and remember her name. We had this conversation in her office. Problem. My location based memory is that I can remember being in the room, I can remember the coffee. I can remember that were like, you know, like connected at the hip. We were like, this would be great. The Paley center would be perfect. She would love to do it. Let's keep talking. So then I talk to Ayal.



Elise Bernhardt - 27:57

I come back to her and I say, well, I think I've got myself a fiscal hub and I think we could do this. And it would be so great if you would be one of the host organizations. And I tell her, it's the Jerusalem Theater. Or I say, it's the Israel Festival. And she said to me, if it was called the Jerusalem Festival, I might be able to do it, but there is no way That I can do it with the Israel Festival. And it happened a couple of times with some of the other people who I spoke to in East Jerusalem. And I had to like go back to Ayal because we almost had a contract. It'd be really good if I can find those.



Elise Bernhardt - 28:51

Yeah, were like on the cusp of having an agreement and I had to go back with my tail between my legs and say to him, you were right, this isn't going to work. He was not happy with me. Although he still, I still remember that he came to the opening in 2022, our first event. And I was really like, so glad to see that he, you know, like I wasn't Persona non grata trying to think of who else we almost. I don't remember who introduced me. Oh, yes, I do. Oh, James. So James suggested that one of the organizations we work with in East Jerusalem, so School the east, the IBDA School of the Arts, which was founded by this Melchem Bader, who is actually Druze. And there's a whole write up about the school in on the website.



Elise Bernhardt - 29:56

So I don't, I'm not going to reiterate that, but Melchem had worked for James at the Israel Museum and he had managed and his job was to try and get people from East Jerusalem to go to the museum. And he was incredibly effective at that. Like, I don't know, there were like four people who went and then there were 40,000. I don't have the numbers exactly correct, but then Melchem, who is a philosopher king and one of the dearest people in the world, founded the school as the only school of the arts in East Jerusalem. And he built it from like one grade to the next grade. So guessing it's at least 10 years old now, maybe a little more. But he had to convince parents that it was okay to send your kid to a school of the arts.



Elise Bernhardt - 30:49

And I remember going to visit and the first thing you walk it was an old Arab house that had been converted into school. It was like the prince of somebody's house probably says something in their website, if they even have a website. And the first thing you see when you walk in and open the doors, there's a big hallway and there's a grand piano in the hallway. Like, that's. And I was like, oh yeah. So that's how he became one of the host organizations.

That was the other thing structurally that. And I don't remember exactly how we came about this to Rejigger the structure. Because what had happened in.



Elise Bernhardt - 31:36

In 2011 and 2013 is people applied with projects and almost inevitably the projects changed, partly because, you know, in what we call disorientation week, every idea you ever had about this place is thrown up on its. On its end. And the collaborations were good and interesting, but they were maybe not as in depth as would have hoped for. So one of the kind of inversions of the structure was we would select host organizations, he would select four cultural organizations, and then the artists would apply to work with them based on their kind of. So one of them was Moose Lala, which was run by this Matan who had, you know, had the rooftop idea maybe from us, maybe not, because we thought an environment, it's like all about echo, ecological sustainability, blah. So we thought, okay, and this would be a great.



Elise Bernhardt - 32:56

And it's in the center of the city. So that was a really important. And he had and still does have a relationship with an organization called Sinsilla, which has since become its own ngo. But under it was like a sister organization. This is the one that was on the library in East Jerusalem that has also has, you know, stuff growing on the roof and now beekeeping and now a separate space. But anyway, they had this strong connection. Who was the melchem in Easterusland at the school, Matan, who had this roof type and strong relationship with Easter Islam. I don't know how we got to the science museum. For the life of me, I don't remember. I don't remember who recommended it. I really love their director, who has since retired. Maya, Maya Halevi. Why can't I remember anybody's names? Anyway, that's in there too.



Elise Bernhardt - 34:08

Really great, nonsense woman who. She became the hub. She became the fine they became because they were the biggest organization. They became the financial hub. And there's a lot in the evaluation that talks about how difficult that was, you know, like gathering all the stuff and processing it through them and getting the money. And yeah, it was a big pain in this for her. But anyway, I don't remember how the science museum, but it just seemed like they worked with artists and it seemed like an interesting location. And they did have. Even though they're like way in like around the campus of the Israel Museum and the library and Givatram, so certainly a bus ride from anywhere. But they became one of the host organizations who was four. Wow. Oh, and this wonderful choreographer had a dance company, Katamon Dance Company. I had known.



Elise Bernhardt - 35:15

I'm looking at his face and it's still not so crazy. What was it? Why can I think of his name? Time? I keep thinking of Ayal Sher. But anyway, this lovely young man who's a choreographer who'd been to New York, who produced festivals in the Mahana Yehuda market and very entrepreneurial. I know his partner, I know his kids. He's. They're listed in there too. But anyway, so they became. And I had seen stuff that he'd done in this court so I knew he was very sort of public performance minded. So he became the fourth hub. They became Katama became the fourth hub organizations. But finding these people. There were so many people I talked to like that was. Each visit was me talking to other potential host organizations, trying to figure out who would be the financial hub.

Elise Bernhardt - 36:32



Like every one of those visits was one of those exploratories and there's probably a whole. Oh shush, you're so noisy. Can you go somewhere else?



Alexandra Nyashina - 36:43

There was,.



Elise Bernhardt - 36:45

There were some very disappointed organizations that I could list, but I don't think it's worth saying. But one organization that we didn't choose hosted a salon. And at that salon, what was Leahy's organization called? This is Art Studio in Talpiot. I have all of these listed. I mean actually it would probably be good to list at least how many organizations we spoke to who ultimately did not become host organizations but in some way, shape or form were involved. Oh, Hanson House, that was another big one. Hanson House was the former leper hospital that became this amazing cultural center. We talked to them about being a host organization and I don't remember what. And I knew their founder and I thought he would be great. And I don't remember the reason that one didn't happen because it could have been a great hub.



Elise Bernhardt - 37:46

A lot of it had to do with where could you be that would be east and West Jerusalem friendly. That was probably the most challenging part of it like every time. And one of the interesting things that I noted was, you know, because the not the whole non normalization business meant that there were a lot of East Jerusalem organizations who just wouldn't have anything to do with us. And once this became an international fellows and people understood that there was no Israeli government money, there was no US government money, there was no government money. Cat fight. I'm telling you, it's like the jungle out here. Once we figured out who like example. So Tari. No, Nasser was somebody. Oh, this is interesting. What's. What was her name? Andy. Andy Arnowitz's daughter whose name I was also a really important source. She.

This. I'm sorry. I'm going to pause for just a.



Elise Bernhardt - 40:25

Brief moment, if you don't mind. Need something? Go ahead.



Alexandra Nyashina - 40:28

No, no. I have a young person here. Who are you? The assistant. This is my personal assistant, Ms. Elise. Please meet Katerina.



Elise Bernhardt - 40:37

Hi, Katarina. Hello.



Alexandra Nyashina - 40:42

Clearly needs attention here.



Elise Bernhardt - 40:44

Good.



Alexandra Nyashina - 40:45

I just want to look at you. Okay, well, now you look at yourself. Would you like to have some breakfast or can you handle it yourself? Excellent. Well, I don't think you're not in school today. There is no school today. And tomorrow. Which is why I'm only available early in the morning, because.



Elise Bernhardt - 41:03

Wait, public school's closed again?



Alexandra Nyashina - 41:06

Yeah.



Elise Bernhardt - 41:07

Oh, it's okay. Parents don't need to work today. And tomorrow they've got a clerical day.



Alexandra Nyashina - 41:13

And some professional development. All good stuff. But I apologize.



Elise Bernhardt - 41:18

No, no, it's fine. Don't worry.



Alexandra Nyashina - 41:21

This time is about you and not about my little be.



Elise Bernhardt - 41:36

Still.



Alexandra Nyashina - 41:36

It was. I do apologize.



Elise Bernhardt - 41:52

No, no, sweetie, it's fine. Don't apologize.



Alexandra Nyashina - 41:55

The compromises. Go do your homework and then you can watch tv.



Elise Bernhardt - 42:00

There you go. Hello. Welcome to parenthood. Yeah, you gotta have some carrots and some sticks. I didn't know there was no school. All right. My Polish friend who's in Poland while her husband, who's Haitian, is here and their five year old is in public school, and he's got a really tricky job that he can't do remotely or any other way. So I wonder what he's doing today and tomorrow, because somehow he's not never able to read the school calendar, which I find, you know, whatever, like, camps now. I stick a kid into all the y. How many times he showed up at school and there's no school. I'm like, can you read the goddamn calendar. Like, what? Okay. Neither here nor there. Andy's daughter, Ariel. Marco. All right, I'll find Ariel's number. And.



Elise Bernhardt - 42:59

Anyway, so she introduced me to people, you know, like, it was random. This is like me as the quote unquote at&t operator. You know, you talk to somebody, they give you five names, they introduce you to, you know, and those. That's what I did over those seven years. And I'd say probably the most instructive, if difficult, but instructive, because the why would have been a great point place to have our. As our. You know, but they had so many changes of administration. I remember going back to them. I remember talking to this Palestinian woman who was in development, and she brought it to her boss, who was Moroccan. And like, we thought that would work. This was after the. That didn't work. Right. Everybody wanted money. No. You know, but they were like, well, you know, what are you paying us to do this?



Elise Bernhardt - 43:53

And in a certain. And I think we actually. We did give money to each organization, each host organization to, you know, like some small compensation for space and for the time, their staff time. Understanding that nobody really had bandwidth. And in certain cases, say. In every case, they'd say it wasn't enough because they ended up re. You know, being who they were. Either. They were all in, like. I'm thinking of the dance guy. He did. He. He and Claudia are choreographer from Mexico. They, like, they fell in love, you know, and they did. They did a film together, and she did a special choreography for a special series they were doing. And. And she did another project. I mean, that woman made it, but he really went. You know, he went 200 in. And. And there were expenses.

he had Just moved in there. And it was this beautiful, light filled studio. And he was gonna. I don't know if he was making a sound studio for recording, whatever, but it was very spacious. And we talked about would he be willing to participate. And he was very like, well, you know, let's see how it goes. He was on the list for if were going to do it again, like, how would we make that happen? There was a music venue started by a Russian, like sort of entrepreneurial Russian guy. And it had a great.



Elise Bernhardt - 50:21

It was really center city right near the light rail, the Maskeka, I think it's called the Muskeka. And I talked to him about being a host organization because it would have been a great music venue. And each of these decisions on who, how, where. I'm sure the advisory committee probably had some input. Ruth, Ruth Cummings would be the person who I probably most depended on to help make these decisions. And there was a lot of back and forth conversations and just to get back to. Because we're back to structure and the sort of flipping it, we had to pick the host organizations and then ask for a call for proposals for people to apply to work with those host organizations.



Elise Bernhardt - 51:20

And once they, once we had sort of narrowed the pool, we would then have the host organizations say, well, we're interested in these artists, and then have a conversation. Like before there was any selection process. You guys need to like interview each other and see if there's some like, rapport or some like ideas that you would like to do together. So, so that the project became. The idea was that the project would become something valuable to the organization as well as something that the artist was really interested in doing. That did not work all the time. I think at the end of the day it worked really well, but it was complicated. It was matchmaking and it was complicated matchmaking.



Elise Bernhardt - 52:13

We also, I think we had 50 applications and we winnowed it down to 12 applicants and which was then going to be winnowed down to four. And I have to say I remember having conversations with at least two of them to try and convince. Viva and Claudia, I think were the two people I had to convince to come, you know, like after they had been selected. I think that the. The battery is wound down. I mean, obviously what I need to do is see if I can find calendars, but I don't know that the actual dates. I mean, I also have to remember that Covid intervened, you know, so between 20 and probably 20, huh? Oh, how did we do this? Everything shuts down in 20. Happens in 22. Did that work? Sorry, I'm trying to think, how did we do that?



Elise Bernhardt - 53:27

Because I couldn't visit in 20, and so we must have had to Dismay decisions by 21 as to who the host organizations were. I wonder if there's any of this in. Oh, my God. How do I even find these, like, Zoom recordings? I do have Zoom recordings. I don't remember what all of them are, but I do have some. Yeah, because we. I would have had to do it. We would have had to select. If people were coming in March, we would have had to select them by March of 22. We would have had to select them by, like June of 21, which means we would have had to have decided who. Who's who. Because the. Yeah, this would have start. How did we do this in 20? Because everything was shut down in 20. I'm gonna have to think that worked.



Alexandra Nyashina - 54:36

Here's a question.



Elise Bernhardt - 54:38

Yes.



Alexandra Nyashina - 54:39

At that point of time, you. You had email.



Elise Bernhardt - 54:44

We had email. We had zoom. We had like all those things. Yeah.



Alexandra Nyashina - 54:47

Is it. Do you still have access to those? Because what I can do, if it's your permission, is get into that email and have AI read how it got done.



Elise Bernhardt - 54:58

Well, the question is if how many of those emails still exist. Yeah, I have no problem with, you know, I have a whole. I mean, I have a separate email account for this, which at the moment has a lot of shit in it, but there's probably a lot I didn't delete.



Alexandra Nyashina - 55:19

I mean, I. I don't know.



Elise Bernhardt - 55:21

Let's see.



Alexandra Nyashina - 55:22

I don't know.



Elise Bernhardt - 55:22

I'm wondering how you can figure out how far back this email account goes. But it was certainly around for. Five, six, you know, once we started Jerusalem International Fellows, I remember that we had to read. We did a whole redesign. I remember Joe was part of the. Helping me figure out who to do the redesign, you know, with the. And that. So we would have built the website and the email. So it must have been 2019ish that it was back to. I don't know if I can figure out how to give you permission to. To get into it. I have no problem with AI reading all the emails for as far back as it goes and who knows what. We'll find out.



Alexandra Nyashina - 56:22

All the stuff that you're talking about, the structure here. It sounds like these are the things that you would probably make a record of just in the conversations with the advisory board.



Elise Bernhardt - 56:33

Right? Right. Yeah. Yes, probably. There are also lots of correspondence with them and lots of. I have to. I have To. I have to get copies of all the E News letters. I don't know if I. If how. I'll figure out how to give you access to my mailchimp. Because the other thing I want to do is I want to download all of the list, you know, the content, the contacts, the contact list, so I can stop using mailchimp. I'm going to do one final letter. But there were. I should. I actually should know how to. I can send you all the e newsletters that I sent out. Over time, those will. But they're not. I mean, I don't know. They'll say some things.



Alexandra Nyashina - 57:29

The easiest way that I would do is literally, you know, maybe give me a username, come up with a password that is easy. And then later on change it out so that I don't have access.



Elise Bernhardt - 57:41

I'm going to close it. So I'm very happy for. Okay. It Mail chip access. And I. Maybe I can do the same thing for Zoom.



Alexandra Nyashina - 57:56

I don't know. Unless you were recording the phone calls on Zoom.



Elise Bernhardt - 58:00

Yeah, not all of them, but some of them. So there is some.



Alexandra Nyashina - 58:05

You know what you were doing.



Elise Bernhardt - 58:07

No, I didn't. And I didn't do all. I. I didn't record all of them, but I did record some of them. So I know those recordings exist because they'll tell me every once in a while that I'm, like, out of juice or out of, you know, like I have to pay more. All right, you need to go attend to your girl. I have homework assignments, and I'm going to try and stick with. I am gonna. Oh, Alexandra, I have your address, but give it to me again because I'm going to stick this in the mail to you.



Alexandra Nyashina - 58:36

3125 Tibet Avenue. T I. Tibet Avenue. Okay.



Elise Bernhardt - 58:48

Bronx. What's the zip?



Alexandra Nyashina - 58:50

A 10463. Apartment 9B.



Elise Bernhardt - 58:56

Apartment 9B. Okay. I'm gonna stick this in the mail to you today, which is the report and also the nice evaluation from 2013. Yeah, I imagine you can take apart and scan.



Alexandra Nyashina - 59:10

She is ready to help.



Elise Bernhardt - 59:13

Thank you. Nice meeting you.



Alexandra Nyashina - 59:16

I like this. I like your necklace and your sweater.



Elise Bernhardt - 59:19

Oh, my necklace. It's. You know what it is? It's a hamster. It's a hamsa. I don't think you can see it so well, but, you know, the hands is a good luck sign. My friend gave it to me. Protection. All right.



Alexandra Nyashina - 59:36

Have a fun day. Thank you. Talk to you soon.



Elise Bernhardt - 59:39

Thanks. Bye. Oh, Aggie.